

GST Data Provider - Pros & Cons

For the Credit Signal Report we look up a third-party buyer's GSTIN to read identity + filing/compliance history. Recommended path: a third-party API provider behind a swappable interface. Recommended pick: Karza (Perfios); alternative: Clear; cheap pilot: Surepass.

Provider	Best for	Pros	Cons
Karza (now Perfios)	Credit / underwriting GST stack	Built for lenders/NBFCs; rich filing history, compliance & turnover signals (not just verification); strong data-intelligence reputation	Enterprise sales motion; pricing opaque; can be pricier
Perfios	Reliable financial-data platform	Enterprise-grade, 99.9% uptime SLA; large client base; now owns Karza's stack	Geared to larger clients; pricing on request
Clear (ClearTax)	Compliance-native (is a GSP)	First-party GSP access; mature GST APIs; good documentation	More filing/compliance-oriented than credit-signal-oriented
Signzy	Customisable KYB onboarding flows	End-to-end orchestrated KYB journeys; good for banks/enterprises	Heavier than plug-and-play; overkill for simple GSTIN lookups
Surepass	Cheap, quick-start verification	Affordable; batch processing; 3000+ clients; fast integration	Thin on filing-history / compliance depth
Others (HyperVerge, Cashfree, Attestr, IDfy, Gridlines, BeFiSc)	Commodity GSTIN verification	Easy, cheap, instant integration	Mostly identity verification; little filing-history depth

Alternative considered: Direct Govt GST Portal (GSTN) - not for MVP

Pros: Authoritative first-party data; no reseller markup; full API surface
Cons: Needs India IT/BFSI company with Rs 2-5 cr capital + Rs 5-10 cr turnover; GSTN contract + security audits; built for filing, not third-party lookups; months of effort - kills the launch-in-weeks goal

Recommendation: Use a third-party provider behind a swappable GstProvider interface. Primary = Karza (Perfios) for filing-history depth; alternative = Clear (a GSP); cheap pilot = Surepass. Cache + cost-log every call.